Mathematics / Secondary

Percentages and percentage change

A percentage describes a quantity out of one hundred. Keep the original amount clear when calculating a change.

Core ideas

1. To find p% of an amount, multiply by p/100.
2. Percentage change = change / original amount × 100.
3. An increase of 12% uses a multiplier of 1.12. A decrease of 12% uses 0.88.

Worked example

A price rises from 80 to 92. The increase is 12. Percentage increase = 12 / 80 × 100 = 15%.

Try it yourself

1. Find 25% of 180.
2. Increase 60 by 10%.
3. A value falls from 50 to 40. Find the percentage decrease.

Check your answers

1. 45
2. 66
3. 20%